B O R O U G H O F E A S T M E R E

Town Hall, Market Square, Eastmere EM1 1AA

Minutes of the Ordinary Meeting of Eastmere Borough Council

Held in the Council Chamber, Town Hall, on Thursday 8 October 2026, commencing at 7.00 pm

Present	Apologies for absence	In attendance
Councillor R. Okafor (Mayor, in the Chair) Councillor J. Brandt Councillor M. Ferreira Councillor P. Hughes Councillor S. Lindgren Councillor A. Nakamura Councillor T. Wiśniewski	Councillor D. Moreau Councillor E. Castillo	K. Ashworth, Chief Executive L. Mensah, Head of Legal and Democratic Services H. Doyle, Democratic Services Officer

45. Declarations of interest

Councillor Brandt declared a non-pecuniary interest in item 49 as a member of the Eastmere Allotment Society.

46. Minutes of the previous meeting

RESOLVED that the minutes of the meeting held on 10 September 2026 be approved as a correct record and signed by the Mayor.

47. Mayor's announcements

- The Mayor thanked the volunteers who supported the Heritage Open Days weekend, which attracted over 3,100 visitors.
- The refurbished Wharf Street library will reopen on 2 November 2026.
- The Remembrance Sunday parade will assemble at 10.15 am at the War Memorial.

48. Questions from members of the public

Two questions had been submitted in accordance with Standing Order 11. Mrs G. Pellow asked when the pedestrian crossing on Mill Lane would be repaired, and the Cabinet Member for Highways replied that the work was scheduled for the week beginning 19 October. Mr F. Adeyemi asked whether the Council would extend the opening hours of the recycling centre during the winter months.

The Cabinet Member for Environment undertook to provide a written answer within ten working days.

49. Allotment rents 2027–28

The Council considered the report of the Head of Parks and Open Spaces proposing an increase in allotment rents of 4.5 per cent. Members noted that the waiting list for allotments stood at 214 households.

Table A: Proposed allotment rents

Plot size	Current rent 2026–27	Proposed rent 2027–28	Concession rate
Full plot (250 m²)	£96.00	£100.30	£50.15
Half plot (125 m²)	£52.00	£54.35	£27.20
Raised bed (10 m²)	£18.00	£18.80	£9.40

RESOLVED that:

(a) the allotment rents for 2027–28 be approved as set out in Table A;

(b) the concession rate of 50 per cent for residents in receipt of pension credit be retained.

Recorded vote on item 49

Vote	Number of members
For	5
Against	1
Abstentions	1

50. Date of next meeting

The next ordinary meeting of the Council will be held on Thursday 12 November 2026 at 7.00 pm.

The meeting closed at 8.42 pm.

Signed ..... Mayor Date .....